

THE UNSHAKEN SELF

The 18 Chapters Study Companion

*A chapter-by-chapter workbook of teachings, Sanskrit vocabulary, daily practices,
and guided reflections — built to be used alongside the book.*

KETUL SHAH

How to Use This Workbook

Each of the eighteen chapters of the Gita is distilled here into five parts: what the chapter teaches, a Sanskrit term worth knowing, the chapter's Daily Practice, and two reflection prompts with space to write.

You do not need to move through this in order, and you do not need to complete a chapter in one sitting. A useful rhythm is one chapter per week — read the corresponding chapter of the book, try the Daily Practice for a few days, then return here to write.

Two companion resources pair well with this workbook: the ***Sthitaprajna Daily Meditation Tracker*** for logging your Daily Practices over 30 days, and the **Book Club Kit** if you're reading this in a group. Both are available in Book Resources.

CHAPTER 1 · ARJUNA VISHADA YOGA

When Life Freezes You

*Understanding the Moment You Feel Stuck***WHAT THIS CHAPTER TEACHES**

The book opens with Arjuna frozen on the battlefield, paralysed by conflicting duties. Confusion isn't weakness — it is often the doorway to real growth, the moment an old way of seeing the world becomes too small to hold your life. Freezing is reframed as a nervous-system response to conflicting signals, not a character flaw, and the chapter teaches you to recognise your own everyday "battlefields" — the kitchen, the office, the mirror — as ordinary and survivable.

SANSKRIT TERM · *Kurukshetra* — The battlefield where the Gita takes place. Symbolically, any place where an inner conflict must finally be faced.

DAILY PRACTICE**The Three-Breath Pause**

Whenever a big reaction rises — the urge to shout, shut down, or say yes when you mean no — pause before acting or speaking, and take three slow, deliberate breaths.

REFLECT & JOURNAL

1. Where is your current "battlefield" — kitchen, office, mirror, somewhere else?

2. Recall a time real confusion led to real growth. What did it teach you?

CHAPTER 2 · SANKHYA YOGA

You Are Not Your Thoughts

*Discovering What Cannot Be Broken Inside You***WHAT THIS CHAPTER TEACHES**

This chapter separates the constantly changing mind — thoughts, emotions, roles — from the steady awareness behind it: the *sthitaprajna*, or person of steady wisdom, whom the Gita describes as untouched by praise or blame, gain or loss. The aim isn't to stop thinking, but to stop mistaking the passing weather of the mind for the sky itself.

SANSKRIT TERM · *Sthitaprajna* — "One of steady wisdom" — a mind that remains undisturbed by praise, blame, gain, or loss.

DAILY PRACTICE**The Mirror Exercise**

Each morning, stand before a mirror for sixty seconds and practise recognising the awareness behind the reflection, rather than getting pulled into self-judgement.

REFLECT & JOURNAL

1. What thought or emotion do you most often mistake for "who you are"?

2. What would change today if you related to your thoughts as passing weather rather than facts?

CHAPTER 3 · KARMA YOGA

Do It Because It Matters

*The Art of Working Without Keeping Score***WHAT THIS CHAPTER TEACHES**

Karma Yoga is full effort paired with released attachment to outcome. The chapter distinguishes true action from mere busyness, and teaches that motivation follows engagement — not the other way around. You do not need to feel ready before you begin; the doing itself, done well, is enough.

SANSKRIT TERM · **Nishkama Karma** — Action performed without attachment to its fruits — full effort, released outcome.

DAILY PRACTICE**One Task, For Its Own Sake**

Once a day, choose one task and complete it entirely for its own sake — not for a reward, not for recognition, expecting nothing in return.

REFLECT & JOURNAL

1. Which of this week's tasks are you doing only for the outcome? What changes if you do it "for its own sake"?

2. Where do you currently keep score with your own effort?

CHAPTER 4 · JNANA KARMA SANYASA YOGA

The Fire That Cleans

*How Learning Burns Away What Holds You Back***WHAT THIS CHAPTER TEACHES**

Real learning is framed as release, not accumulation. Growth requires letting go of calcified old certainties that have hardened into walls — knowledge that only adds facts without ever burning anything away rarely changes a life.

SANSKRIT TERM · *Jnana* — Knowledge — here, specifically the kind that burns away illusion rather than simply adding more facts.

DAILY PRACTICE**The Bonfire List**

Once a week, sit down and write one old belief you are ready to release.

REFLECT & JOURNAL

1. What belief have you outgrown but not yet let go of?

2. What would you attempt if that belief no longer held you back?

CHAPTER 5 · KARMA SANYASA YOGA

Free in a Busy World

*How to Live Simply Without Moving to a Mountain***WHAT THIS CHAPTER TEACHES**

Renunciation isn't about escaping your life — it's about holding your commitments, possessions, and ambitions with an open hand instead of a closed fist, so you can be fully engaged without being owned by any of it.

SANSKRIT TERM · **Sannyasa** — Renunciation — in the Gita's practical sense, an inner letting-go rather than a literal departure from life.

DAILY PRACTICE**The Open Palm Meditation**

In a short daily pause, notice what you are gripping most tightly right now, and practise holding it a little more loosely.

REFLECT & JOURNAL

1. What are you gripping most tightly right now — a plan, a person, an outcome?

2. What would "holding it loosely" look like today?

CHAPTER 6 · DHYANA YOGA

The Quietest Room Is Inside You

*A Beginner's Map to Inner Stillness***WHAT THIS CHAPTER TEACHES**

A practical, unintimidating map into meditation for people who believe they "can't sit still." Rather than asking for more willpower, the chapter anchors practice to something you already do every day without fail.

SANSKRIT TERM · *Dhyana* — Sustained, focused meditation — attention held steady on one point.

DAILY PRACTICE**The Anchor Breath**

Before every meal, pause and take six slow, deliberate breaths before the first bite.

REFLECT & JOURNAL

1. What has stopped you from starting a meditation practice before?

2. Where in your existing daily routine could you anchor a moment of stillness?

CHAPTER 7 · JNANA VIJNANA YOGA

Seeing the Thread

*How Everything in Your Life Is Quietly Connected***WHAT THIS CHAPTER TEACHES**

This chapter practises noticing connection rather than separation — between your inner and outer life, your choices and their ripples, yourself and everyone around you.

SANSKRIT TERM · Prakriti — Nature — the field of matter, emotion, and circumstance that surrounds and moves through the self.

DAILY PRACTICE**The Thread Walk**

Take a ten-minute walk with one task only: notice how things around you are connected.

REFLECT & JOURNAL

1. Where have you been treating something as separate that is actually connected — to your work, your relationships, your habits?

2. What thread, once you see it, changes how you'll act tomorrow?

CHAPTER 8 · AKSARA BRAHMA YOGA

What You Remember Last, Shapes You First

*The Power of Your Final Thought Each Day***WHAT THIS CHAPTER TEACHES**

On the imperishable, and on the outsized power of whatever occupies the mind in its final, most impressionable moments each day.

SANSKRIT TERM · **Akshara** — The imperishable — that which does not decay or change.

DAILY PRACTICE**The Pillow Thought**

Every night, choose one genuine, worthy thought to take with you into sleep. Not a list — one thought.

REFLECT & JOURNAL

1. What usually occupies your mind in the last minutes before sleep?

2. What's one thought worth choosing on purpose tonight?

CHAPTER 9 · RAJA VIDYA RAJA GUHYA YOGA

The Simplest Secret

*Why the Most Powerful Truths Hide in the Obvious***WHAT THIS CHAPTER TEACHES**

The "royal secret" isn't hidden or esoteric — it's usually so simple it gets overlooked: wholehearted devotion and presence brought to ordinary things.

SANSKRIT TERM · **Raja Guhya** — "Royal secret" — a truth too simple and open to be hidden, yet easy to miss.

DAILY PRACTICE**The Whole-Heart Hour**

Choose one hour of your day and give one activity everything you have — no divided attention.

REFLECT & JOURNAL

1. What's an "obvious truth" you know intellectually but haven't actually practised?

2. Which hour of your day could become a Whole-Heart Hour?

CHAPTER 10 · VIBHUTI YOGA

Spotting Greatness Everywhere

*Training Your Eyes to See Wonder in the Ordinary***WHAT THIS CHAPTER TEACHES**

Training attention to notice the extraordinary already present in ordinary life and ordinary people, rather than only in rare, dramatic moments.

SANSKRIT TERM · **Vibhuti** — Divine glory or manifestation — the trace of the extraordinary within ordinary things.

DAILY PRACTICE**The Glory Journal**

Before bed, write down three magnificent things you noticed that day — not just things you're grateful for, things that struck you as remarkable.

REFLECT & JOURNAL

1. What's one "ordinary" thing today that was, on closer look, extraordinary?

2. Who in your life do you take for granted who is quietly remarkable?

CHAPTER 11 · VISHWARUPA DARSHANA YOGA

The Bigger Picture

What Happens When You Zoom Out from Your Problems

WHAT THIS CHAPTER TEACHES

Uses the Gita's vision of the universal form — echoed by the "Pale Blue Dot" photograph of Earth from Voyager 1 — to practise zooming out from a problem to see its true size.

SANSKRIT TERM · **Vishwarupa** — The universal or cosmic form — a vision revealing the true scale of existence.

DAILY PRACTICE**The Satellite View**

Spend two minutes imagining your life, and your current problem, from high above.

REFLECT & JOURNAL

1. What problem feels enormous right now that might look different from a wider view?

2. What's genuinely permanent in your life, and what merely feels that way today?

CHAPTER 12 · BHAKTI YOGA

Love as a Daily Verb

*Turning Every Relationship into a Practice of the Heart***WHAT THIS CHAPTER TEACHES**

Devotion as an active, daily practice rather than a feeling you wait to arrive — small, consistent acts of care matter more than grand gestures.

SANSKRIT TERM · **Bhakti** — Devotion — love expressed through consistent action, not only feeling.

DAILY PRACTICE**The Devotion Note**

Every day, write one handwritten line of appreciation to someone.

REFLECT & JOURNAL

1. Who deserves a handwritten note from you this week?

2. Where in your relationships have you been waiting to "feel" love instead of practising it?

CHAPTER 13 · KSHETRA KSHETRAJNA VIBHAGA YOGA

The Watcher and the Garden

*Knowing the Difference Between You and Your Life***WHAT THIS CHAPTER TEACHES**

Distinguishes the field — your body, mind, and circumstances — from the knower of the field, the awareness observing it. Learning to tend your "garden" without confusing yourself with it.

SANSKRIT TERM · *Kshetra / Kshetrajna* — The field, and the knower of the field — the observed, and the observer.

DAILY PRACTICE**The Narrator Minute**

At any moment, pause for sixty seconds and narrate your own experience from the outside, as an observer.

REFLECT & JOURNAL

1. What part of your life have you been fused with rather than observing?

2. What changes when you describe today's stress as "the field," not "me"?

CHAPTER 14 · GUNATRAYA VIBHAGA YOGA

The Three Colours of Your Mood

Why You Feel Bright, Heavy, or Restless — and What to Do

WHAT THIS CHAPTER TEACHES

The three gunas — sattva (clarity), rajas (restlessness), and tamas (heaviness) — offer a non-judgemental way to read your own state and choose the right response for it.

SANSKRIT TERM · **Guna** — Quality — the three qualities (sattva, rajas, tamas) that colour every state of mind.

DAILY PRACTICE**The Mood Weather Report**

Each morning, take sixty seconds to honestly name your current inner "colour" — without judging it.

REFLECT & JOURNAL

1. Which guna has been most present this week — sattva, rajas, or tamas?

2. What does today's "weather" actually need from you?

CHAPTER 15 · PURUSHOTTAMA YOGA

The Upside-Down Tree

*Understanding Where You Come From and Where You Are Going***WHAT THIS CHAPTER TEACHES**

Uses the Gita's image of the cosmos as an inverted tree, rooted above, to explore where your own "roots" — your true source of orientation — actually are.

SANSKRIT TERM · **Purushottama** — The supreme being — the source beyond even the ordinary sense of self and world.

DAILY PRACTICE**The Root Question**

Each morning, ask yourself: "Where am I growing from today?"

REFLECT & JOURNAL

1. What are you currently rooted in — fear, obligation, love, ambition?

2. What would it look like to grow from a steadier root tomorrow?

CHAPTER 16 · DAIVASURA SAMPAD VIBHAGA YOGA

The Two Wolves Inside You

Choosing Which One to Feed Every Single Day

WHAT THIS CHAPTER TEACHES

Names the divine and demoniac tendencies present in everyone, and the small, ordinary daily choices that feed one or the other.

SANSKRIT TERM · *Daivi Sampad / Asuri Sampad* — Divine and demoniac tendencies present, in varying measure, in every person.

DAILY PRACTICE**The Wolf Check**

Each night, ask honestly: which wolf received more of my attention today?

REFLECT & JOURNAL

1. Which wolf did you feed most today, honestly?

2. What's one small choice tomorrow that would feed the other one?

CHAPTER 17 · SHRADDHATRAYA VIBHAGA YOGA

You Become What You Believe

*How Your Quiet Convictions Shape Your Loud Life***WHAT THIS CHAPTER TEACHES**

Explores the three kinds of faith or conviction, and how underlying beliefs — often unexamined — quietly determine visible choices and character.

SANSKRIT TERM · **Shraddha** — Faith or conviction — the quiet, often unexamined belief that shapes visible choices.

DAILY PRACTICE**The Belief Audit**

Once a month, gently question one thing you have long assumed was true.

REFLECT & JOURNAL

1. What's one belief steering your life that you've never actually examined?

2. Where did that belief come from?

CHAPTER 18 · MOKSHA SANYASA YOGA

The Open Door

*Living Free While Being Fully Alive in This World***WHAT THIS CHAPTER TEACHES**

The Gita's closing teaching on liberation — not as withdrawal from life, but as full, unclenched engagement with it. The book's synthesis chapter, bringing the previous seventeen practices together.

SANSKRIT TERM · **Moksha** — Liberation — freedom that is fully engaged with life, not withdrawn from it.

DAILY PRACTICE**The Morning Vow & The Evening Release**

A two-minute ritual: begin the day from a chosen centre (the Vow), and end it in a chosen peace (the Release).

REFLECT & JOURNAL

1. What would "freedom" look like if it didn't require leaving your actual life?

2. What's one vow you want to begin tomorrow with?

Closing Note

Eighteen chapters, eighteen practices — none of them requiring more than a few minutes a day. The Gita's case, echoed throughout The Unshaken Self, is that steadiness is built in small, repeated moments, not in one dramatic transformation.

If a single practice from this workbook is still part of your week a year from now, this companion has done its job.

— KETUL SHAH